SIP continuation case study · Q&A preparation

Answers use only evidence in the project reports as of 5 Nov 2026. Where something is unknown, say so.

Toughest questions

1. Why month-12 active SIP continuation as the North Star?

It's the stated company goal, and it captures whether the habit survived the first year. 'At least one successful instalment in the last 30 days' is generous on purpose: it counts someone who skipped a month and came back. I use instalment-level metrics only as diagnostics.

Still unknown: Whether month 12 is the right horizon for Groww's economics; I haven't seen cohort curves.

2. Why public online conversations?

They're the fastest way to find mechanisms in investors' own words, at scale, without accessing anyone's account. I used them to generate and rank hypotheses, then tested those in interviews.

Still unknown: Public posts over-represent complaints and Reddit users, so they can't size anything.

3. How did you select the final 450 records?

From 2,518 that passed a topic gate and a first-person gate. Reddit's 1,553 matches were sampled down to 280 candidates. Beyond that, the selection rule wasn't recorded, and it's disclosed as not reproducible.

Still unknown: The exact selection, and the 16,487 and 2,068 records that weren't retained.

4. Is 78.2% the actual SIP lapse rate?

No. 352 of 450 coded records are lapse-labelled because the filters targeted SIP problems. It describes the sample, not investors.

Still unknown: The real lapse rate; that needs Groww cohort data.

5. How reliable is a Cohen's kappa of 0.50?

Moderate, and preliminary: 11 of 20 in round 3, up from 4/20 and 7/20. Enough to trust patterns across dozens of records, not any single label.

Still unknown: First-hand status (409/450) was never human-checked; 38 disagreements were reconciled by one reviewer, none independently.

6. Why is payment failure prioritised over platform trust?

Trust has more stories (64 vs 52) but trust issues rarely end a SIP on their own and sit mostly in operations. A failed instalment counts towards automatic cancellation after three in a row, and its status, reason and retry live in the app. So exit 1.0 vs 0.5, addressability 0.9 vs 0.3.

Still unknown: The weights are analyst judgements.

7. Why does payment failure rank fourth when you remove the weights?

Because by raw volume it is fourth. The first-place ranking depends on my view of exit relevance and addressability, which is why I disclose it. It survives noise (945/1,000 resamples, 937/1,000 weight nudges) but not removing the weights.

Still unknown: Whether my weights match Groww's internal data on which issues actually precede a stop.

8. How did the primary interviews challenge your original conclusion?

The engine pointed at failed payments. In interviews only 2/5 had a failed debit or error, while 4/5 planned around when cash arrives, and P05's misses were intentional. So I widened the problem to cash-flow fit and clarity of options.

Still unknown: Five interviews can't establish how common each pattern is.

9. Why cash-flow friction as the problem to solve?
It shows up in every source: the timing and balance behaviour in 4/5 interviews, 10/20 survey respondents aligning the date to payday, 9/20 skipping or pausing on purpose, and amount-vs-cash-flow and skip/pause stories in the public data. It's also addressable in the app: dates, amounts, skips and explanations.
Still unknown: Whether solving it moves month-12 continuation.

10. Why an AI Companion instead of a deterministic FAQ?
The answer depends on the investor's own state, like when the next debit is, and people ask in their own words and follow up. The rule engine covers the common paths and is the fallback; AI handles phrasing and combinations. Code, not the model, decides what's allowed.
Still unknown: Whether users prefer the conversational format to a well-designed status screen; untested.

11. How do you stop an LLM from inventing Groww policies?
The model only sees 22 reviewed facts from 13 sources and the SIP's state. Every draft passes 15 deterministic checks, covering grounding, numbers, advice, urgency, pressure to pay and unavailable actions, or it's replaced by a checked rule-based answer. A human audit of 58 claims found 57 correct; the one error is now blocked.
Still unknown: Paraphrases the checks miss; scoring is regex-based.

12. What happens when Groq is unavailable?
The rule-based engine answers with the same checks, and the reply is labelled, for example 'Rule-based · AI limit reached'. It never shows a fallback as live AI.
Still unknown: Live quality under real load; the free tier allows roughly 130–140 live answers a day per model.

13. How do you know the Companion is useful to actual users?
Today, only from P05's qualitative feedback. I haven't run task-based tests and haven't collected P03's and P04's feedback, which is below the assignment's three-user requirement.
Still unknown: Usefulness for eligible Groww first-SIP investors.

14. Why haven't you shown actual retention improvement?
Month-12 continuation takes a year and requires Groww's cohort data and a controlled rollout. I've defined the North Star and leading indicators so that an experiment could measure it, but I won't claim an effect I haven't measured.
Still unknown: Everything about impact.

15. What would you do with another four weeks?
First, recruit six to eight eligible Groww first-SIP investors and run real-task sessions. Second, run the controlled live evaluation on the final build. Third, prototype the payday-aware date and pre-debit readiness. Fourth, design the experiment with guardrails.
Still unknown: —

16. Only one of five interviewees is a confirmed Groww first-SIP investor.
Correct, and it's on the slide. I use the interviews for behaviour, not Groww-specific claims, and the segment is labelled provisional.
Still unknown: Groww-specific friction points.

17. The survey is small.
20 starters from a convenience sample on mixed platforms, 8 on Groww. I report it as x of 20 and never mix it with interview counts.
Still unknown: Anything about prevalence.

18. AI-classified first-hand records?

409 of 450 were labelled first-hand by the AI and never human-checked. That's why first-hand only feeds the evidence-quality term, and why the disclosure is on slide 3.

Still unknown: First-hand label accuracy.

19. No formal task-based usability study?

Right. The pre-registered T1–T5 protocol wasn't feasible in time. I show only the qualitative feedback that actually exists.

Still unknown: Task success and time on task.

20. No Groww account integration?

Deliberate. The Companion uses illustrative scenarios, and every action is a labelled simulation. A real version would read status from Groww's system of record.

Still unknown: Integration constraints.

21. Real rollout and regulatory dependencies?

Every fact needs policy and compliance sign-off, there can be no advice or return claims (SEBI expectations), a privacy review is needed before personal data is used, and model capacity is needed beyond a free tier.

Still unknown: Groww's internal review requirements.

Final evaluator scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Score	Deductions and risks	Highest-value improvement
Assignment completeness and requirement alignment	15	**11**	All parts present: engine and 1-slide explanation, decomposition, research, segment, problem, MVP, success metrics, risks. Deductions: MVP testing has 1 qualitative participant against the required ≥ 3 (−3); the AI Evidence Log public link isn't in the deck (−1).	Run sessions with at least two more target users and add the Evidence Log link.
Problem framing and metric definition	10	**9**	Exact North Star; clear decomposition; missed ≠ churn; stop ≠ redeem. −1: leading indicators are reasoned, not validated against outcomes.	Show which indicator you'd validate first and how.
Research and evidence quality	15	**9**	Strong transparency, but: undocumented 2,518 → 450 selection; κ 0.50 on n = 20; 1/5 confirmed Groww participant; 20-person convenience survey; Reddit 62%.	Recruit eligible Groww first-SIP investors.
Insight, segmentation and problem synthesis	10	**8**	Clear pivot from payment failure to cash-flow fit; pathways tied to evidence. −2: segment provisional and not sized.	Size the segment with any available data, or state how Groww would.
Opportunity prioritisation and product judgement	10	**9**	Explicit formula, sensitivity, and the 'fourth without weights' disclosure. −1: solution ICE scores pre-date the interviews and weren't rescored.	Rescore the solutions after the pivot.

MVP quality and product execution	15	**12**	Working, deployed, contextual, simulated actions, labelled fallback. −3: illustrative data only; live AI limited by the free tier; fixes on a branch not yet deployed at deck time.	Deploy the final build and record a short demo video as a fallback.
AI quality, safety and governance	10	**8**	Gate with 15 checks, fallback, claim audit, separate reporting. −2: 22/25 is below the 90% bar; the post-fix run is pending; the engine's live AI is unevaluated.	Complete the controlled post-fix run and report it as regression.
Validation and learning	10	**5**	Honest, but thin: one participant's qualitative feedback, no task-based tests, no impact data.	Two or three real-task sessions with the template.
Storytelling, visual communication and delivery	5	**4**	Clear arc and a memorable pivot. −1: slides 3, 9 and 10 are dense for a live audience.	Rehearse slides 3 and 9 to two sentences each.
Total	100	**75**	Submission quality, not business impact: no retention effect has been measured.	